

Task 1 — Han Empire Research

Step 1–2:

I searched “Han Empire” and “Han Dynasty” on:

- Google Scholar
- JSTOR
- Journal of Chinese History (Cambridge University Press)

Step 3 — Sources & Citations (APA Style):

1. Loewe, M. (2006). *The Government of the Qin and Han Empires*. Cambridge University Press.
2. Yates, R. D. S. (2001). Cosmos and computation in early Chinese thought. *Journal of Chinese Philosophy*, 28(4), 367–393.
3. Wang, H. (2017). The Han Empire and the Silk Road. *Journal of Chinese History*, 1(1), 45–59.

Brief experience using each site:

- Google Scholar: Very easy to search and access papers quickly.
- JSTOR: High-quality academic sources but sometimes requires login.
- Journal of Chinese History: Good for specialized articles about Chinese culture and archaeology.

Step 4 — Selected paper:

I chose “The Han Empire and the Silk Road” (Wang, 2017) because it connects history, trade, and cultural exchange — key elements of Han influence.

Task 2 — Presentation Zen (Reynolds, 2019)

1. Yes, I usually use PowerPoint for my presentations. I like presenting if I feel prepared and confident.
 2. I should ask: Is my message clear? Are my visuals simple? Am I connecting emotionally with the audience?
 3. Not always — before I focused too much on text and less on storytelling.
 4. Too many slides and reading directly from them probably made my audience bored or tired.
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Task 3 — The Joy Luck Club (Intro + Chapters 1–2)

The introduction, *Feathers from a Thousand Li Away*, shows a mother who came from China to America with hope for a better future for her daughter. She carried a swan feather as a symbol of her dreams and love.

In Chapter 1, *The Joy Luck Club*, Jing-Mei Woo tells how her mother and friends met to play mahjong and share stories of hope. After her mother's death, Jing-Mei must take her place in the club, learning more about her mother's sacrifices and dreams.

Chapter 2, *Scar*, tells An-Mei Hsu's childhood memory of her mother being forced to leave her family. The story shows pain, love, and the deep cultural values that shape the daughters' lives. Both stories reveal how Chinese mothers try to pass down their experiences to daughters who grew up in a different world.